Global Value Rotation

ETF CORE (70%) · DEVELOPED-MARKET EQUITIES · EUR

Objective

Earn the long-run premium of cheap equity markets with smaller losses in bear markets: hold the cheapest developed countries and sectors, and halve equity exposure when the market turns. This ETF core is 70% of the value strategy; a stock satellite (30%) is in construction.

Approach

Value decides what to hold; a risk rule decides how much. The value signal is slow and is given time to work through a holding buffer; the risk rule is checked every month and never goes below 50% equities.

Key facts

Strategy type	Systematic, long only, country and sector rotation
Benchmark	MSCI World Value Net EUR
Universe	14 MSCI countries · 11 MSCI World sectors
Holdings	8 UCITS ETFs (4 countries, 4 sectors), 50-100% invested
Rebalancing	Monthly
Value signal	E/P, B/P, dividend yield vs own 10-year history
Risk rule	50% cash if 2 of 3 indicators red (trend, credit, breadth)
Currency	EUR, unhedged
Costs in backtest	0.10% per trade · 0.25%/yr ETF fees
Track record	Backtest since January 2006 · live from Nov 2026

Portfolio for October 2026

RISK RULE: 100% INVESTED

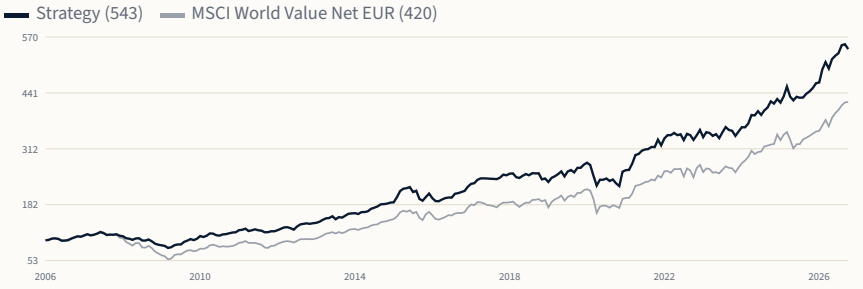
Sector	**Consumer Staples**	12.5%
Country	**Germany**	12.5%
Country	**France**	12.5%
Country	**Denmark**	12.5%
Sector	**Energy**	12.5%
Sector	**Utilities**	12.5%
Country	**Hong Kong**	12.5%
Sector	**Real Estate**	12.5%

Performance (%)

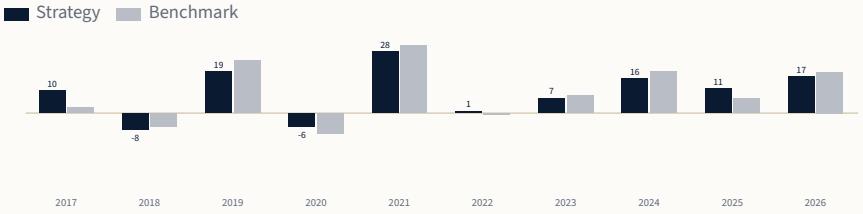
	1M	3M	YTD	1Y	3Y*	5Y*	10Y*	SINCE 2006*
Strategy	**−2.0%**	**1.8%**	**16.7%**	**22.1%**	**15.4%**	**11.4%**	**9.9%**	**8.5%**
Benchmark (MSCI World Value)	0.1%	4.5%	18.8%	22.9%	16.4%	12.0%	9.9%	7.2%
Difference	*−2.1%*	*−2.7%*	*−2.1%*	*−0.9%*	*−1.0%*	*−0.5%*	*−0.1%*	*+1.3%*

* annualised

Growth of 100 since December 2005



Calendar-year returns (%)



Risk statistics (since January 2006)

	STRATEGY	BENCHMARK
Volatility	10.4%	13.5%
Sharpe ratio	0.70	0.44
Maximum drawdown	−30.8%	−53.7%
Beta vs benchmark	0.68	1.00
Tracking error	6.4%	–
Average equity exposure	88%	100%

Monthly comment

In September 2026, the strategy returned −2.0% against +0.1% for the benchmark. Since January 2026, it is +16.7% against +18.8%. Since 2006, 100 has grown to 543 against 420, with a worst loss of −31% against −54%. The risk rule is at 100% for the coming month.

Sources: Bloomberg (MSCI country and sector indices, valuation ratios, euro money-market rates); Thoth Ledger calculations.

How the strategy works

1. **Measure**
   At each month end, the earnings yield, book yield and dividend yield of 25 indices (14 countries, 11 sectors).
2. **Score**
   Each ratio is compared with the line's own 10-year history (z-score) and the three are averaged: a market is cheap when it is cheap versus its own past.
3. **Select and keep**
   Buy the 4 cheapest countries and the 4 cheapest sectors; keep a line while it stays among the 6 cheapest, so a value bet is not sold too early.
4. **Dose the risk**
   If at least two of three indicators are red (MSCI World below its 10-month average, euro high yield lagging short government bonds, fewer than half of the 25 lines in an uptrend), half the portfolio moves to cash; it returns to 100% when fewer than two indicators are red.

Why it should work

Cheap markets have tended to outperform over the following years (Asness, Moskowitz and Pedersen, 2013), but they can keep falling in a crash. Simple trend and credit signals have historically flagged long bear markets (Faber, 2007). Halving exposure on those signals keeps most of the value premium while limiting the losses that make value hard to hold.

Main risks

- Value can lag for years when expensive growth leads (2016-2026).
- The risk rule can cut just before a quick rebound: 28 switches in 20 years.
- Eight lines can overlap (a cheap sector and a cheap country can be the same bet).

Glossary

Sharpe ratio. Return above the euro money-market rate divided by volatility.

Maximum drawdown. Largest fall from a previous peak.

Tracking error. Volatility of the return difference with the benchmark.

z-score. Distance from the average, in standard deviations.

Important information

Student research project by Noah Doose (MSc Financial Markets & Investments, SKEMA Business School). Thoth Ledger is not an investment firm and offers no product or service. All figures are hypothetical backtest results of a model portfolio, computed on monthly index total returns in EUR with ETFs as proxies, net of the costs stated, before taxes. The rules were chosen among several pre-registered candidates; the clean out-of-sample test is the live record from November 2026. Past performance does not guarantee future returns. This document is not investment advice.